

FRAME BY FRAME

SkillUp Course Catalogue:

Component Design Justification

1. Component Overview

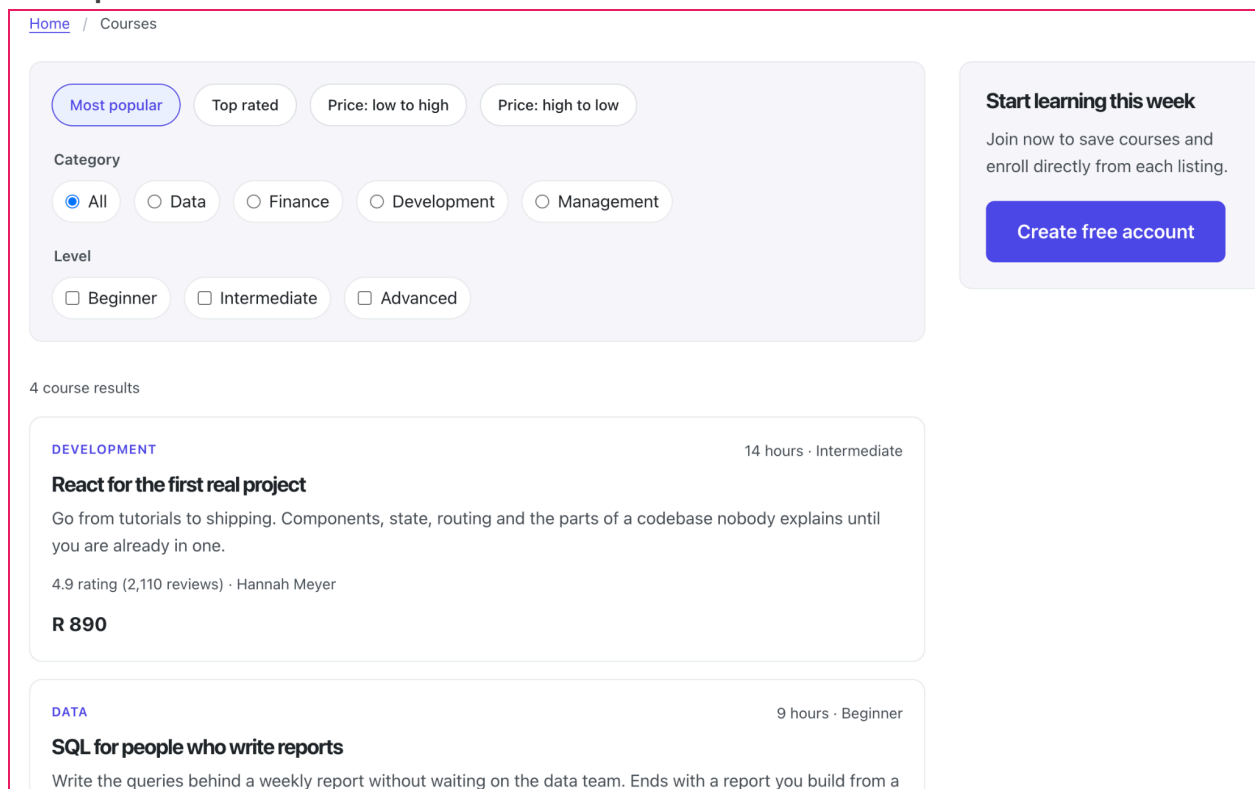


Figure 1: SkillUp course overview

The SkillUp course catalogue was designed to help users find, compare and access courses easily.

The client specifically wanted a traditional list rather than a grid of cards. The catalogue therefore presents courses as **informative list items**, with important course information visible without requiring the user to open each course.

2. Design Requirements

The catalogue needed to:

- Use a traditional list layout.
- Show relevant course information.
- Allow users to search for courses.
- Allow users to sort and filter courses.
- Make courses and controls easy to interact with.
- Keep the information clear and easy to scan.

3. Research Influence

Our UX research on Coursera, Udemy and Khan Academy helped guide the final catalogue design.

The Khan Academy evaluation showed that searching was more efficient when the user already knew which course they wanted. Its course result areas and filters were also easy to interact with. However, browsing could require more scrolling.

Our Udemy research showed that making the whole course area clickable creates a larger interaction target. It also showed that card-based layouts can take up more space and display fewer courses at once.

These findings supported our decision to use a **searchable, sortable list with large clickable course rows**.

4. Fitts's Law

Fitts's Law focuses on the size, distance and positioning of interactive targets. The larger and easier to reach a target is, the easier it is for the user to select.

This was applied to SkillUp by making the **course row a large clickable area** rather than only making the course title clickable. The sort and filter controls are also given enough space and are clearly separated from one another.

The goal is to make important actions easy to select without requiring users to click on small or closely positioned targets.

5. Course Selection

Users can select a course from the list to access its full course information. The catalogue therefore provides the information needed for initial comparison, while the course page provides more detailed information.

6. Client Requirements

Client Requirement	SkillUp Solution
Traditional list	Courses are displayed as a vertical list instead of a grid.
Informative list	Important course information is displayed directly.
Searchable	Users can search for specific courses.
Sortable	Users can change the order of the course results.
Easy to browse	Filters help users narrow the available courses.
Find out more	Selecting a course opens its detailed course page.
Easy interaction	Large clickable areas and clear spacing support Fitts's Law.

7. Conclusion

The final SkillUp catalogue focuses on making course discovery **simple, informative and efficient.**

The design combines the client's requirement for a traditional list with findings from our UX research. Search, sorting and filtering help users find relevant courses, while large clickable course rows make the main interactions easier.

The overall design allows users to **find a course, compare their options and access more information** without unnecessary interaction.